

What makes a good story?

Vocabulary

Pound (n): about 450 g



Scale (n):

Judge (n): 法官

To take to court (n): 状告

Story 1

A farmer said to a judge that he used a scale to weigh butter (for a baker who bought butter from him) in the following fashion: “Your honour, since long before the baker started buying butter from me, I have been buying a pound loaf of bread from him.

⁹Every day when the baker brings the bread, I put it on the scale and give him the same weight in butter. ¹⁰If anyone is to be blamed, it is the baker.”

This was said when the baker took a farmer to court because he (the baker) thought the farmer was cheating him. The baker bought butter from the farmer each day, but one day the baker found the farmer was giving him less butter than he was paying for. But in fact, the baker was cheating the farmer, as we can see above.

Story 2

¹There was a farmer who, every day, sold a pound of butter to a baker. ²One day the baker decided to weigh the butter to see if he was getting the right amount, which he wasn't. ³Angry about this, he took the farmer to court.

⁴In court, the judge asked the farmer if he was using any measure to weigh the butter.

⁵The farmer replied, “Your honour, I am primitive. ⁶I don't have a proper measure, but I do have a scale.” ⁷The judge asked, “Then how do you weigh the butter?”

⁸The farmer replied, "Your honour, since long before the baker started buying butter from me, I have been buying a pound loaf of bread from him. ⁹Every day when the baker brings the bread, I put it on the scale and give him the same weight in butter. ¹⁰If anyone is to be blamed, it is the baker."

Questions

Which story is better?

Why?

References

The stories are adapted from <https://www.quora.com/What-is-the-best-short-story-around-200-words>